



Continuing Education Policy

1. **Continuing Education (“CE”):** The Green Dog Dental Veterinary Center executive team has sole discretion to amend the information defined herein.
2. **CE is explicitly defined below:**
 - a. Registration to courses relevant to veterinary medicine and approved by the California Veterinary Medical Board
 - b. Lodging and travel, if applicable and approved in advance
 - c. Program materials, textbooks, etc. relevant to veterinary medicine
 - d. Personal veterinary equipment, if applicable and approved in advance
 - e. Membership fees to organizations relevant to veterinary medicine
3. **CE Budget:** Employees shall have a budget defined in their employment offers for continuing education expenses, commencing at the end of the probationary period delineated in their employment offers. CE renews at the start of each calendar year. CE budget does not roll over annually.
 - a. The CE budget may include payment for further certifications and degrees. Green Dog Dental Veterinary Center (“Company”) will pay for all fees and tuition related to additional certifications and degrees, if applicable. However, the employee must stay with the Company for a period of either 2 to 3 years, depending on the certification and price of schooling, after receiving the agreed-upon license or certification. The exact period of time is listed in the employee’s Continuing Education Program and Expense Agreement (“Agreement”), which must be read in conjunction with this policy. In the event of any conflict between this policy and the Agreement, the terms of the Agreement will govern. If the employee terminates his/her working relationship with the Company before the end of the designated period, the employee will need to reimburse the Company for the entire cost of the schooling, which is further specified in the Agreement.
4. **CE Protocol:** CE expenses must abide by the following protocol:
 - a. A CE request must be made via SLACK for approval.
 - b. Following approval, the CE request is paid directly by the Company.
 - c. Employee must complete any official documentation associated with CE approval.
 - d. If applicable, employees must provide signed completion of approved courses.

5. CE Limitations: CE use is contingent on the following:

- a. Approval is at the discretion of the Company.
- b. **All reimbursable expenses are explicitly excluded**
 - i. CE is paid directly by the Company.
 - ii. Company has sole discretion to approve reimbursable expenses.
- c. Meals, taxi fares, bus fares, automobile rental, tips, memorabilia, and other incidental expenses are excluded from CE.
- d. Employee will be responsible for expenses in violation of the above procedures and policies.
- e. All equipment (ie: loupes, lights, etc), program materials, textbooks etc., purchased as part of CE shall be the property of the Company.
- f. Renewal expenses must follow CE protocol.

6. Veterinary Conference Attendance Policy:

- a. Attending conferences is important for the continued growth and education of those working in the veterinary field.
- b. The Company will reach out via SLACK to those employees selected to attend the conference. Unfortunately, due to financial constraints, not all employees will be invited to attend the conference every year. Employees are selected based on their staff level and work performance. Although we encourage invited staff to attend, conference attendance is voluntary; it is not a mandatory job requirement. Therefore, hours/days spent at the conference are unpaid.
- c. Travel (to and from city of conference location), lodging fees (for lodging described in conference attendance offer, without modifications), and conference fees are paid for by the Company.
- d. If an employee is invited to a conference and the fees associated with his/her attendance exceed his/her allotted yearly CE allowance, the employee will **not** be expected to make up the difference in costs.
- e. If work is performed during conferences, the employee will be compensated appropriately for that time. "Work" is defined as required time commitments specifically related to the employee's everyday job responsibilities (i.e. staff meetings, client calls, client communications, etc).